Finding and accessing additional support

Practical guide for students | D17-ST

Additional support can help when a difficulty continues beyond what classroom clarification can resolve. Start with the problem you are experiencing and find the service equipped to help with it.

1. Describe the difficulty

Bring a specific example, such as an unclear paragraph, feedback comment or inaccessible resource. Note when the problem occurs and what you have already tried.

2. Identify the kind of help

Ask your teacher about subject content and task expectations. Academic skills services may help with planning, reading and writing; English-language provision may address continuing language development. IT and other services address different needs.

3. Find the official route

Use your institution's support page or ask for a referral. Check eligibility, booking steps, cost if any, and whether support is online or in person. External university resources do not automatically give you access to their services.

4. Prepare for the appointment

Bring the task instructions, relevant work and one or two questions. Explain your goal: "I want to understand how to connect evidence to my argument." Ask what preparation is required.

5. Agree on a next step

Clarify what you should practise, which resource to use and whether another service is needed. Support can develop your skills; it does not remove your responsibility for the submitted work.

6. Follow up

Try the agreed action and check whether it helps. If the referral does not work or the problem continues, return to the referring person or service and ask about another route.

7. Example

You keep receiving comments that your paragraphs are difficult to follow. You bring the task, rubric and one paragraph to an academic skills appointment. The adviser helps you identify the missing connection between evidence and explanation. You practise revising a section and agree when to check progress.

8. Quick checklist

☐ I can explain the problem and my goal.

☐ I have checked the right support route.

☐ I know what to bring or prepare.

☐ I have an action and a follow-up plan.

9. When to seek further support

If no suitable service is available, ask your teacher or program contact what alternatives exist. For continuing English-language difficulties, ask specifically about additional provision or referral. For health, disability or wellbeing concerns, use the relevant specialist service.

10.Supporting sources

RMIT University Vietnam. (n.d.). Student Academic Success. Open resource

Provides a Vietnamese university example of academic learning support, learning advisers and self-study resources.

Monash University. (n.d.). Learn from feedback. Student Academic Success. Open resource

Supports using adviser feedback to identify priorities, develop strategies and check progress in a follow-up session.